



the techniques of air power were initially developed, military aircraft became an integral part of warfare by World War II. The advent of jet power, and sophisticated electronics perfected during and after the Cold War, has now turned the aircraft into a feared weapon over the 21st century battlefield.

More than 100 years after the Wright brothers first took to the air in the first powered, controlled, heavier-than-air machine, the political, social, and economic challenges are different, yet, in many respects, remarkably similar. Today, aviation and spaceflight are critical tools for the improvement of the human condition and powerful instruments of positive change.

This book is the story of that most remarkable achievement of the 20th

century – flight. Using superlative historical images and extraordinary new photography to illustrate an excellent text, this book is a fitting tribute to the courage and efforts of the pioneering individuals and organizations that inspired the first 100 years of aviation.

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